

1st to \$1M+

- Strategic approach leveraging local customers for social proof
- I was one of two founding members of the outbound sales team. We were given names of districts we should reach out to, instructions on how to obtain the data we needed, and a Gmail account. That's it.
 - We downloaded the data, created spreadsheets, and created processes as we went.
 - I had total creative freedom in my messaging strategies, and was able to run my own campaigns from top to bottom.
 - Rather than approaching educators with traditional sales tactics, I used a different approach. Human-centered. Respectful. Patient. Kind. Appreciative. Because that's what we all deserve.
 - I experimented with everything I could to generate the most positive results. I tested the differences in the way my name appeared on outgoing mail (Morgan Escott? Morgan from Treering? Morgan @ Treering?). I tried out different Gmail account icons (a photo of me? Treering's logo?). I played with different email signature strategies (Logo or no logo? Colors? Emojis? Longer, or shorter?).
 - Eventually, our team started working in PersistIQ which was a whole new world (🎵). We had access to variables, A/B testing, reporting, and more. We could adjust the length of time between steps and send messages as replies to existing threads. It was magical.
 - Here are a few of the things I came up with in Persist, during my early years at Treering...
 - These campaigns helped me build a pipeline with efficiency and purpose. I exceeded my first year's target by 17%, these messages evolved into teamwide templates even as we brought on more SDR team members, and I eventually went on to become the first SDR to reach \$1M+ in revenue.
- Page: Key Campaigns
- Page: Methodologies and Nuances
- Page: Conclusions/Results

Managing 2,9XX+ Accounts

- 51 States
- 565 Districts
- Segments diagram and count
- Annual research
 - Data types for contacts and accounts
- Hot zone prioritization based on estimated value and number of customers in the district
- Sales Cycle
- Smart spreadsheet creation
 - Automated color-coding via conditional formatting that updated regularly based on new data pulled into the sheets based on updates in Salesforce.
 - Extended beyond what Salesforce was capable of in terms of organization and prioritization.

Finding \$3M+ in CRM

My direct report strongly requested to develop her current role further because she was starting to feel unfulfilled after several years as an SDR. She wanted to brand out, utilizing her strengths in back-end processes like research. This aligned perfectly with company needs, so

Here's what I did:

- Cross-referenced users in the system against current employees, identifying accounts that needed updated ownership.
- Looked into accounts owned by executive leadership, who rarely work individual sales opportunities
- Pulled up accounts with no listed value, because something has to be broken in order for that to occur.
- Solved for enrollment data, free and reduced lunch percentages, and identified private schools as needed.
- Dug into the endless amount of duplicates in our system, identifying them by their unique school ID number rather than something like the school's name, which could easily return matches in other districts and even states if searched.
- Filtered by factors like date the account was last modified, and by whom.
- BOOM. There were \$3M+ in accounts that hadn't been worked in a long, long time.

This was enough to justify the duties my direct report asked for. So, I got approval from the Head of Sales and crafted a new role from scratch.

I single-handedly determined her:

- Process from start-to-finish
- Trained her on processes she wasn't familiar with that were essential to her role (ex: merging accounts)
- Developed KPIs to determine what success looked like.
- Prepped and organized all of the initial reports so she could hit the ground running (there were MANY variations), and gave her two dashboards: one that captured the big-picture scale of the project, and another that dialed in on her current phase of the project and showed her performance in relation to the goals I set for her.

Then end result was:

- A VERY happy direct report (she was extremely thankful)
- WAY more opportunity in the pipeline to be distributed and worked appropriately
- And we had someone in a new role that could be a great asset in the future (we discussed taking her role even further in the future, allowing her to perform initial research on accounts before they're handed to the SDR for outreach — this was always done by the SDR, but this new role opened up an opportunity to save the SDR an IMMENSE amount of time by not having to individually research each of their schools in such depth before reaching out.).

Leadership

- Remote Team
 - 4-6 SDRs on average with shifts over time
 - Responsible for weekly 1:1's, their performance in respect to their KPIs, discussing and seeking out development opportunities as needed, running monthly team meetings with slide decks, attending weekly leadership meetings (and often MANY additional meetings to collaborate with Marketing, Product, Engineering, Operations, and/or Support), collecting and communicating feedback from my team to the Head of Sales, and helping with daily troubleshooting and problem-solving.
 - Ran a Slack channel for team updates, announcements, discussions, brainstorming, and general team-building.

- I used this to build out additional resources for them that were easy to find like Treering's sales playbook, essential guides on process (ex: tagging in Outreach), content from Treering's blog that was timely to share, etc.
- I was the only SDR manager (there were two others as well as myself) to create a comprehensive system of reports for my team. This made their lives MUCH easier because they no longer needed to track down difficult to find and often outdated reports that the team had been using for ages. Instead, they could navigate to Reports, click on our team's folder, and find everything they needed in one place.
 - I trained them on how to add and adjust filters themselves, and duplicate them if they needed to make changes.
 - This resulted in my team growing their understanding of Salesforce significantly, and many of them specifically thanked and recognized me for it. ("Do the other managers do this for their teams too??" "I was thinking about quitting before, but you made it so easy to understand and I really appreciate the time you took to work with me." etc.)
- PTA Councils/Districts
 - I felt very strongly about experimenting with a top-down approach. Our typical process involved reaching out to individual schools and doing our best to pitch Treering's products and services. Sometimes this worked, and sometimes the school would tell us they had no decision-making power and that their publishers were decided by the school district instead. We were typically guided to move on, and try the next school. Instead, I wanted to continue working those leads because all of these folks were telling us the same thing – we just needed to get approval from the school district. We were approved in some districts, but the maintenance of these contracts had fallen behind due to competing priorities. Why shouldn't this be a huge priority for us, since we can win more schools at a time and make an even greater impact on Treering's growth AND the number of schools who might be able to restart their yearbook programs or create one for the first time. It's a win-win, but it also went against the daily norm. I tried it anyway. I got nothing but positive responses, and many of them were kind enough to share my information with all of the principals or PTA presidents in their region. That's HUGE, because the next time we reach out to those schools (if they don't reach out to us first), we'll have the backing of social proof from their own organization. This opens them up to conversations they might be closed off to otherwise.
 - Gwinnett PTA Council in Georgia allowed us to present during a virtual meeting that gathered all of the PTA leaders from their individual schools in one place. I developed a beautiful, personalized slide presentation which was presented by our Head of Sales.
 - This led to conversations with other PTA councils nearby, and facilitated an opportunity for statewide promotion with the Georgia PTA.
 - Due to this success, I trained the team on my process and I developed sequences in Outreach to make my templates available teamwide.
 - This grew in popularity and our Head of Sales was getting more district leads than ever before. For some, we literally just needed to register as a vendor and then ALL of the schools in the district were allowed to work with us. Others just required simple RFPs, and things of that nature.
 - Our Head of Sales got so overrun with requests that he needed someone to help, so one of my direct reports became the lead for district contract and vendor requests which allowed us to work with SO. MANY. MORE. SCHOOLS. This is all because I tried a thing. <3

- Content Committee

- When I joined Treering, Sales and Marketing were one team – the Sales & Marketing team. My direct supervisor was actually the Head of Marketing. But at some point, Marketing split into its own team. Our boss was the Head of Sales, and someone else was hired to run Marketing. This is definitely what Treering needed at the time, because marketing efforts like social media were not always prioritized. But, it also created a gap in communication between the two teams. Marketing produced the templates and campaigns that sales used for daily outreach as well as everything else that went with it, but it was difficult for the salespeople to request changes or provide feedback if they had thoughts on how our messaging should sound. So, the Content Committee was formed and the Head of Sales came to me immediately, asking me to run it. I accepted, and I formed a team of 3-5 employees that expressed interest, and we became an essential bridge between these departments.

- I ran weekly Content Committee meetings (often with slides!) to discuss what was on our to-do list, chat about updates from leadership, brainstorm new ways we could be effective, etc.
- Audited, updated, and organized our content in Outreach to form a unified content library that was strategically sorted by collections and tags. This made it MUCH easier for our outbound team, which had grown to 20+ members, find what they needed and work that much more efficiently. They didn't need to search and struggle – it was all right there.
 - We created processes around this along with documentation and team training, so that the system could stay as beautiful as we hoped it could be.
- Sequence writing. Since I was already a key player in writing our annual, yearlong campaigns in Outreach, it was natural for the Content Committee to play a key part in this as well. We collaborated with Marketing regularly and were responsible for nearly all of the outbound messaging from top to bottom including:
 - Gathering internal feedback with an anonymous survey that went out 1-2 times per school year (typically over Winter Break, and again in May/June).
 - Collecting that feedback and turning it into an actionable list of insights.
 - Collecting data on the previous year's sequence engagement data, and turning that into another actionable list of insights.
 - Coordinating with Product, Support, and Marketing to ensure we were reflecting the latest information on our products and services.
 - Writing drafts based on last year's sequences with all of the above in mind and also segmenting for ALLLL of our audiences, writing different variations for each.
 - Planning out the number of steps best suited for the audience type, and mapping out a calendar for the campaign that stretched from the beginning of August to the end of May.
 - Including variable formatting for the most customization possible and coordinating with the Head of Sales and as well as Operations to ensure we were pulling over all of the data we needed from Salesforce and that the triggers operated correctly.
 - Working directly with Outreach representatives when needed to problem-solve things that weren't working correctly OR ask them if an idea we have is possible ("Can we do XYZ, does your system allow for that?").
 - Performing EXTENSIVE QA to ensure there were no typos, errors, or outdated information.
 - Running our drafts past Marketing and Head of Sales for approval.
 - Managing any last-minute fixes that might come up after the sequences are turned on and available for the team.

- Taking requests for seasonal or sales cycle templates throughout the year, and creating them in Outreach and making them available as needed.
- Thought leader in Salesforce/Outreach
 - Championed Outreach
 - When we made the decision as a team to part ways with PersistIQ, I championed Outreach as a great solution for us and after many demos of many products, leadership agreed that Outreach was by far the most feature-rich option that suited our needs best. I'm so proud I could help our team make a high-level decision like that that turned out so well <3.
 - Variable Formatting
 - I understood Outreach's variable code format possibly better than anyone else at Treering, and quickly became a go-to resource for complicated formulas. (If this, then that, then this, but only if that kind of logic). I also requested much-needed mappings from our CRM that allowed us to craft the gorgeous personalization we needed (ex: school district name, address in cases of sending samples, etc.).
 - I took advantage of (and trained my team to use) the often-forgotten "Personal Note" field in Outreach, which was a field on each contact that you could put WHATEVER YOU WANT. Want to list all of the schools nearby? Search up all of the contacts in that district and mass-apply a Personal Note. Boom. Now you can bring strong social proof to their emails. Did you notice a teacher had an adorable dog or loved one of your favorite books when you did research and came across their "About me" page? Put it in their Personal Note before you move on to the next contact. BOOM, you've got personalization that you never could have dreamed of before. I have no idea why no one else bothered with this, myself and my team found it HIGHLY effective.
 - Bulk Imports/Updates
 - Why do a thing 3,000 times if you could accomplish the exact same result by doing a thing one time? Our team's research was tedious, and extremely in-depth for a huge number of accounts.
 - Instead of updating each Salesforce page one by one and switching tabs to click on the next list in my report and then waiting for the page to load for the next contact, I worked via spreadsheet for maximum efficiency.
 - I downloaded my account list as a CSV, imported it into Google Sheets for automatic cloud-based saves, and worked from there.
 - When I had the data I needed, I went to Salesforce, clicked on Accounts, went to the Import section, uploaded my CSV, mapped Salesforce fields to my spreadsheet with a few easy clicks, and watched it do the work for me.
 - If there were any errors, I got an email instantly and I'd address it as-needed.
 - I was one of the only people to operate this way and I have no idea why. This is, by far, the more intelligent way to work. I encouraged others to do the same whenever possible.
 - Individual Dashboards
 - The outbound team operated with three dashboards: a big-picture all-sales dashboard, an outbound team dashboard, and a dashboard for each of the smaller SDR teams within the outbound team. These are all fantastic, but they didn't do quite what I wanted – I wanted to see my own personal work in dashboard format. I wanted to see how many accounts I had left to research, a breakdown of my accounts according to engagement status, my own personal revenue goals and whether I'm meeting them, etc.

- One day, I wrote it down. It turned into a detailed breakdown of something that we didn't currently have: a dashboard that reflected the results of the outbound team member viewing it with their own stats and progress. It was all totally possible, it just needed to be built.
 - I showed it to the Head of Sales, and he loved it.
 - A little while later during one of our executive leadership offsites, he told us he was going to be working with Operations to develop an individual SDR dashboard based on my initial work.
 - It turned into an essential tool for the team, especially during extremely detailed summer research.
- Report & Account View Creation
 - I loved Salesforce so much that I quickly became a key player in creating all of the team-wide reports and account views we used on a regular basis.
 - I created variations for every situation under the sun including a few that people didn't realize were possible to create ("I didn't know I could make a list of all of the people I sent samples to, this is so cool!").
 - I trained the team on the differences between views and reports (which are similar in appearance but for very different use-cases) and various best practices.
 - I helped the team troubleshoot use and the process of creating their own views on a regular basis (they would send me a message when they had trouble!).
 - Reports were essential to our workflow. We needed to know exactly how many schools were in the system to work, and we needed to pull up lists schools and the prospects within those accounts along with all of their details so that we could do our work properly.
 - Sadly, official reports were difficult to come by and many of them were outdated.
 - In almost all of these instances, I created my own version that was updated to include new fields we didn't have before and MANY other factors.
 - Aside from optimizing older reports, I also truly enjoyed puzzling out a new report that we've never had before. There were so many that we needed, but didn't have because it was difficult to solve for.
 - One often-requested report was something that pulled up a list of schools where SDR had clicked the "Is Yearbook Advisor" on at least one of the contacts.
 - Having this list (or inversely a list of schools where they haven't yet identified a yearbook advisor), would be a complete game-changer. I admit it WAS nearly impossible due to how our accounts and contacts were connected and the fields available, but I managed to do it.
 - It also listed how many active/recently-contacted prospects the SDR had at each school they owned along with a benchmark on the report graphic drawing a line at two contacts (so they could at a glance see how many accounts were above or below this line), and in the report listing below it featured conditional highlighting for the yearbook advisor as well as schools that didn't have two active prospects.
 - This is HUGE because we strongly recommended that SDRs work at least 2-3 prospects per account (not just one person!) for the best results.

- Over time I mastered reports based on accounts, contacts, tasks, activities, performance, and more.
 - Through trial and error I mastered bucket fields and so much more.
 - It was honestly incredibly rewarding, and people came to me whenever they had a “What if we had a report that...” idea. I loved it.
- Transitioning from Contacts to Person Accounts: A Story of Tragedy and Troubleshooting
 - During the latter portion of my time at Treering, executive leadership decided to move away from using Contacts in Salesforce, and transition to Person Accounts instead.
 - It was a huge departure from our previous way of working. This transition was necessary so that the company could achieve larger goals, but it was a tumultuous time for the team.
 - We could no longer add people to an account. The schools were accounts, and the prospects were ALSO accounts and we had no built-in way to associate them. It also changed the way we add people into the system, the way we pull them up after they’re created, the way we add them to sequences in Outreach, and the way Outreach syncs with Salesforce.
 - The interface and fields everyone was used to were gone, we had to figure out new processes as we went to achieve the same result as before the transition.
 - All of our contact views we used to pull up prospects in various locations or sales cycle stages were obsolete
 - All of our reports, and therefore all of our dashboards, relating to contacts had to be reconfigured.
 - We endured long stretches of downtime
 - The workarounds we were developing to continue working in Outreach were mildly successful at best.
 - I was KEY in troubleshooting and finding efficient ways to continue working during this time. I spent nearly all day every day on video calls with my remote team members, walking them through issues and sharing screens to help work through issues together so they can understand HOW I’m fixing it so they can try it themselves the next time.
 - I also spent a lot of time in our Slack channel reassuring them that it would all be okay lmao (they were UPSET and rightfully so – management decided to make this change in August. Right as schools were starting their next school year. It’s our biggest sales push of the year and we were in chaos) and explaining some of the reasoning behind leadership’s decisions. It was never meant to be that much of a struggle — they worked with a third party consulting company that specializes in optimizing CRM systems for large companies, and they were told it would all be quick and easy. It was not quick OR easy, haha.
 - I jumped in to help reshape as much as I could.
 - I prioritized the report system I built for my team so they would reflect Person Accounts accurately (a serious challenge due to the way contacts related to accounts, which was much different than how accounts relate to other accounts).

- I did the same for our teamwide reports where possible (especially those that connected to dashboards, so that the dashboards would reflect correctly).
 - I re-created all of our contact views as Person Account views instead. It didn't fix everything, but it did restore a sense of normality and some processes that were very similar to our original workflow.
 - My team thanked me many times for my approach. I'm glad they appreciated it – I did as much as humanly possible to make that time easier for all of us.
- SDR Monthly Training
 - In addition to weekly all-sales meetings and monthly small-team meetings, our schedule also typically included a monthly meeting just for the SDR team. This was their time to get updates directly from the Head of Sales and chat/brainstorm processes, ideas, concerns, etc.
 - As time went on, he got much busier and these meetings were often pushed back or cancelled to give people more time to work. In one of our leadership meetings with the Head of Sales, he asked myself and the two other SDR team leads if it was worth keeping on the schedule or if we should cancel it indefinitely.
 - I honestly think the SDR meeting was very important, so I vouched for it and posed it as an opportunity for training on SDR-specific topics and best practices.
 - (I remember a time before these meetings were implemented, and it felt difficult to get time for questions or outbound topics in the all-sales meeting where they mostly focused on the inbound/closing team. My coworker and I would joke about how many meetings they could go without mentioning us or without us speaking, lmao.
 - I didn't want us to get back to that place and I had plenty of ideas to share, so I took on the meeting myself. It took the form of a workshop-style open format meeting where everyone could participate.
 - As a 20+ employee team that was all remote, it was difficult to find time to chat about our daily process and what worked best for us. It's totally natural when you're in-person and sitting next to someone – you'll say, "OH this subject line is testing so well" and share it with a few people nearby. When you're working remotely, it's way more difficult to see how others work and how they handle the daily struggles of our job. This created a space for that.
 - I would pose difficult questions or objections or situations we ran into when talking to a prospect over the phone or via email, and we would all talk about what worked best for us.
 - I created an outstanding slide deck with a lot of humor that left room to write down everyone's responses, and we used that to create a living document of everyone's best responses to tough questions or approaches/ideas they might have.
 - It went over VERY well, I got great feedback, and several team members requested it as a regular meeting topic. I was happy to oblige and continued!
 - The other SDR team leads joined as well as the Head of Sales and they would jump into the discussion from time to time, but all of the planning and slide creating and running of the meeting was done by me :).

- I brought people together to help build relationships across time zones!
<3

- Internal Process Website

- The outbound process at Treering was complex. They didn't do anything to make it that way, it's just the nature of it – there are lots of small details to consider, different places to put different information, and different things to do in different situations based on different variables.
- We noticed that as we brought on new hires, eventually growing the SDR team to 20+ members, they were overwhelmed by the amount of information they needed to process in a short amount of time. They weren't familiar with Salesforce and Outreach, and it was all new to them.
 - Leadership addressed this by adjusting our onboarding process and implementing scheduled training classes and shadowing before the new hires start working, which helped a lot.
 - Even then, it took almost a full school year cycle for the process to “click” for most folks. At some point around then, a lightbulb would go off (every time! It was so interesting to see everyone have the same experience!) and they would just get it. They would go, “Oh, THAT's why we do that. Of course. I don't know why I didn't get that.” But it took time for them to get there. How can we help speed up that light-bulb moment for them?
 - Well, as a manager I realized that despite their weeks of training, they were having a really hard time visualizing the process of what to do when. It's like having a flowchart in your mind, but it's a complicated flowchart so it's easy to get lost if you don't have it memorized.
 - To solve that, I made that brainchart into a real chart :D.
 - I used MindNode to map out our ENTIRE process. It was an insane amount of work, but very worth it.
 - I posted it on a private Wix website that turned into our internal SDR-specific help-site. It guided new employees through:
 - the tools/tabs they should always have open
 - the extensions they should have added to Chrome
 - the process they should take broken down into easy to understand sections (ex: Research, Adding to Sequence, etc.).
 - Help Centers for Outreach, Salesforce, and our other tools and platforms
 - Which Treering employee they should contact based on what kind of question they have (ex: should they go to their SDR manager for a district contact question, or head of sales?).
 - This website was used in the next year's round of training and remained an ongoing source of clarity for the team.
 - It's something I'm very proud of, and it's honestly the only way to properly show anyone what we really do. Yes, we send emails and make cold calls. But it's so, so, so much more than that behind the scenes. It takes research, data entry, organization, dedication, and insane attention to detail and time management.